



SAINT PIERRE
LEARNING RESOURCES

ENGLISH COMPOSITION

College Composition

Claims, Evidence & Reasoning

College • First-Year Writing

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Teacher Guide

Level: College • First-Year Writing

Standard / objective: Course objective — Develop a focused arguable thesis, evaluate evidence, and connect evidence to claims through explicit reasoning.

Source / course note: Course-level objective; no accreditation or universal equivalency claimed.

Before this lesson: Write complete paragraphs and distinguish fact from opinion.

Model and discuss: Use the fictional 68-of-100 survey as evidence of this sample's evening library use. Explain why it supports considering later hours, but does not establish what all students need.

Watch for: Repeating a statistic is not analysis; a small fictional sample is not a real campus research finding.

Suggested sequence: 5-minute launch, 10-minute model, 20-30 minutes of practice, then a 5-minute exit ticket. Use separate paper for extended writing.

Learning supports

AIG: Develop an alternative explanation and propose better evidence to test it.

504: Offer chunked tasks, reduced copying, extra time, and breaks as specified in the learner's plan.

EC: Use separate claim, evidence, and reasoning boxes before combining a paragraph.

ESL: Rehearse: This evidence supports ___ because ___. A limitation is ___.

Adapt these suggestions to the current learning plan. Print on US Letter paper at actual size; keep the key separate. One teacher may use the resource with their own students; no public posting or resale.



Student Directions & Practice

Revise weak claims, evaluate source notes, and build an evidence-reasoning paragraph.

Directions: Complete every item. Show work or cite evidence. For open responses, answer in complete sentences.

- 1.** Turn “School matters” into a focused arguable thesis.

- 2.** Identify the claim in: Cities should extend library hours because evening access supports working learners.

- 3.** Name one credibility question for a source.

- 4.** Distinguish evidence from reasoning.

- 5.** Write a counterclaim to the library-hours position.

- 6.** Draft a concession sentence.

- 7.** Order these paragraph moves: evidence, claim, analysis.

- 8.** Write a 150-word argument using the provided fictional survey data: 68 of 100 evening students used the library after 6 p.m.



Assessment / Exit Ticket

Work independently. Show your reasoning. Use extra paper if needed.

1. A fictional survey finds that 12 of 20 evening students use a tutoring center. Write a cautious claim supported by this sample.

2. Explain one limitation and what additional evidence would strengthen the claim.

Reflection: What helped you decide? What do you want to practice next?

Score each task: 2 = accurate with clear reasoning; 1 = partly correct or missing reasoning; 0 = incorrect or no evidence. The reflection is not scored.

Answer Key & Teaching Guidance

1. Answers vary; must be specific, debatable, and supportable.
2. Cities should extend library hours.
3. Examples: author expertise, publication process, date, evidence, conflicts of interest.
4. Evidence supplies support; reasoning explains how support proves the claim.
5. A reasoned opposing position.
6. Acknowledges a valid limitation before reaffirming the claim.
7. Claim, evidence, analysis.
8. Rubric: clear thesis, accurate use of 68/100 data, reasoning, counterclaim, conventions.

Exit ticket guidance

1. Example: Tutoring is used by a majority of the surveyed evening students. Avoid a claim about all students or about causes.
2. The sample is small and may be unrepresentative. A larger, more representative survey or usage records would strengthen the evidence.

Next teaching move: Use the worked model again if the concept is unclear. If the answer is correct but reasoning is incomplete, ask for an explanation. Offer the extension once both tasks are secure. Scores guide instruction; they are not standardized mastery cutoffs.